

Aakashsha Jain

Department of Economics, Iowa State University
173 Heady Hall, 518 Farm House Lane, Ames, IA 50011, USA
aakashsha@iastate.edu · aakashshajain.com · [Google Scholar](#) · [LinkedIn](#)

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics, Iowa State University, USA	May 2027 (expected)
M.Sc. in Economics, Shiv Nadar University, India	2020
B.Sc. in Economics, University of Calcutta, India	2017
(Minor: Mathematics & Statistics; First-Class Honours)	

FIELDS OF INTEREST

Labor Economics, Agricultural Labor, Development Economics, Rural Development, Economics of Education, Migration, Applied Microeconomics

JOB MARKET PAPER

[“The Rise of H-2A: Causal Evidence on Guestworker Substitution for Settled Farm Labor”](#)
solo-authored

PUBLICATIONS

Manternach, R., **Jain, A.**, Orazem, P.F., & Soborowicz, L. (2025). [“Are College Towns Really Recession Proof?”](#) *Growth and Change*, 56(4): e70064.

Jain, A., Montenegro, C., & Orazem, P.F. (forthcoming, 2026). “Youth Labor Markets in High- and Low-Income Countries.” In K. Leicht (Ed.), *The Oxford Handbook of the 21st Century Economy and Society*. Oxford University Press.

WORKING PAPERS AND WORKS IN PROGRESS

-
- “Returns to Farming Among Iowa State Alumni” (with I. Cho and P.F. Orazem)
 - [“College Wage Premiums in India: Trends and Spatial Decomposition, 1987–2012”](#) (solo-authored)
 - [“An Overview of the 2024 Iowa State University Alumni Survey”](#) (with A. Andrade, J. Eyles, K. Kimle, P.F. Orazem, and R. Unal)
 - “Does Broadband Close the Rural Education Gap?” (with L. Han and J.V. Winters)
 - “Firm Entry and Serial Entrepreneurship Among Iowa State Alumni” (with D. Lin and P.F. Orazem)

POLICY REPORTS

-
- **Jain, A.**, Lin, D., & Orazem, P.F. (forthcoming, Nov 2026). “Graduating in a Downturn: Business Cycles and Entrepreneurship Among Iowa State Graduates.” *Agricultural Policy Review*.
 - **Jain, A.**, & Chandio, R. (forthcoming, Nov 2026). “Who Hires H-2A Workers in Iowa, and for What?” *Agricultural Policy Review*.
 - Crespi, G., & **Jain, A.** (2026). [“Where Do They Go? Migration Patterns of Iowa State University Alumni.”](#) *Agricultural Policy Review*. Covered by *Axios Des Moines*.
 - Andrade, A., Eyles, J., **Jain, A.**, Kimle, K., Orazem, P.F., & Unal, R. (2025). [“How a Land Grant College Affects Business and Job Creation.”](#) *Agricultural Policy Review*.

CONFERENCES AND PRESENTATIONS

Southern Economic Association (SEA) Annual Meeting, Houston, TX (job market paper)	Nov 2026
Agricultural & Applied Economics Association (AAEA) South Asia Section	
Graduate Student Symposium (job market paper)	Oct 2026
USDA Agricultural Marketing Service, FAME 2.0 Release Webinar (invited speaker)	Oct 2026

AAEA Annual Meeting, Kansas City, MO (job market paper; Data Visualization Challenge)	Jul 2026
Midwest Economics Association Annual Meeting, Chicago, IL	Mar 2025

HONORS AND AWARDS

Selected Paper (\$200 award), AAEA South Asia Section Graduate Student Symposium	2026
First Place, USDA Agricultural Marketing Service and AAEA Local Food Economics Data Visualization Challenge (with A. Basha and H. Lee)	2026

- \$1,200 first-place team prize and \$1,200 in AAEA travel support

TEACHING

Instructor of Record, ECON 3530: Money, Banking, and Financial Institutions	Spring 2025
Teaching Assistant, Iowa State University	Fall 2022 – Spring 2026

- ECON 1010: Principles of Microeconomics; ECON 1020: Principles of Macroeconomics; ECON 2070: Quantitative Methods in Economic Analysis I; ECON 3530: Money, Banking, and Financial Institutions

Teaching Assistant, Shiv Nadar University, India	Fall 2018 – Spring 2021
--	-------------------------

- Econometrics (graduate course); Logic and Scientific Methods (undergraduate course)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, Department of Economics, Iowa State University	Spring 2024 – Present
Research Assistant, Indian School of Business, Hyderabad, India	Summer 2022
Research Assistant, IFMR LEAD (development research center), India	Aug 2021 – Mar 2022
Research Assistant, King's College London (project based in India)	Jun 2020 – Jul 2021

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Referee: *Growth and Change*; *Journal of Development Effectiveness*

Discussant: SEA Annual Meeting (2026); AAEA South Asia Section Graduate Student Symposium (2026); Midwest Economics Association Annual Meeting (2025)

Session Moderator: AAEA Annual Meeting (2026)

University: Elected Chair, College of Liberal Arts and Sciences, and Senator, Department of Economics, Graduate & Professional Student Senate (2023 – 2024)

SKILLS

Software: Stata, Python, $\text{\LaTeX}$

Restricted Data: Special Sworn Status, U.S. Census Bureau; Federal Statistical Research Data Center project No. 3044 (restricted American Community Survey and Numident microdata)

Outside Economics: Machine Learning: A Signal Processing Perspective (EE 425)

Languages: English (fluent), Hindi (native)

REFERENCES

Dr. John V. Winters
Co-Major Advisor
Professor
Iowa State University
winters1@iastate.edu
460B Heady Hall
Ames, IA 50011
515-294-6263

Dr. Peter F. Orazem
Co-Major Advisor
University Professor Emeritus
Interim Department Chair
Iowa State University
pfo@iastate.edu
267 Heady Hall
Ames, IA 50011
515-294-8656

Dr. Amani Elobeid
Teaching Professor
Iowa State University
amani@iastate.edu
166D Heady Hall
Ames, IA 50011
515-294-8122